

- (c) Gujarat – Tea
(d) Kerala – Rubber

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

Kerala is the largest rubber producing (2023-24) state in India. Kerala is a correct match for rubber.

18. Which of the following is a stimulus crop?

- (a) Wheat (b) Maize
(c) Tur (d) Tea

U.P. P.S.C. (GIC) 2017

Ans. (d)

The stimulating crops include tea, coffee, tobacco, opium, poppy, datura, hemp and betel nut etc. while wheat is Rabi crop and maize and arhar are Kharif Crops.

19. With reference to the "Tea Board" in India, consider the following statements :

1. The Tea board is a statutory body.
2. It is a regulatory body attached to the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare.
3. The Tea board's Head Office is situated in Bengaluru.
4. The board has overseas offices at Dubai and Moscow.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

Tea is one of the industries that, which by Act of Parliament comes under the control of the Union Government. The genesis of the Tea Board India dates back to 1903 when the Indian Tea Cess Bill was passed. The Bill provided for levying a cess on tea exports the proceeds of which were to be used for the promotion of Indian tea both within and outside India. The present Tea Board set up under section 4 of the Tea Act 1953 was constituted on 1st April 1954. Significantly this body comes under the Ministry of commerce and Industry, GOI. It is headquartered in Kolkata. It is worth mentioning here that, at the time of question the board had overseas offices at Dubai and Moscow. Currently Tea Board has one office located at Moscow.

(iii) Other Plantation Crops

*According to agriculture ministry plantation crops includes **Coconut, Areca, Cocoa, Cashew and Palm**. Whereas according to commerce ministry plantation crop includes Tea, **Coffee and Rubber**. So Coconut, Areca, Cocoa, Cashew, Palm, Tea, Coffee and Rubber are Plantation crops of India.

* According to data of Agriculture Statistics at a Glance, 2023 Gujarat is the largest producer of tobacco among all states of India. According to figures of the year 2022-23, **58.09%** of tobacco production of India takes place in Gujarat.

*According to figures of the year 2022-23 major tobacco producing states of India are -

Gujarat, Andhra Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh and Karnataka.

*States having the largest area of land under tobacco cultivation in India (in 2022-23) are: **Gujarat** (192.85 thousand hectares), **Karnataka** (76.00 thousand hectares), Andhra Pradesh (58.00 thousand hectares) and **Uttar Pradesh** (23.00 thousand hectares).

*According to the Agricultural Ministry of India, top three **Coconut producing states** in the year 2023-24 are :

1. Karnataka (28.78%), 2. Tamil Nadu (28.50) and Kerala (25.84%). Karnataka is the highest producer of Coconut in India.

* Globally Indonesia, Philippines and India are major Coconut producing countries in 2023.

* Many types of Spices are grown in 'Kerala' that is why it is also called as 'Garden of Spices';

* According to figures of the year 2023-24 Final Estimate, **Madhya Pradesh** is the top producer of spices.

*From ancient times, Kerala has been famous in the world for its production of spices.

***Cloves** are the flower-buds of medium-sized evergreen plant of *Eugenia caryophyllata* family. It is a variety of spices having medicinal significance too. According to the figures of the year 2023-24 (Final data), clove is cultivated in **Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Karnataka**.

* According to figures of annual report 2023-24, top three state in Arecanut production are - 1. Karnataka, 2. Kerala and 3. Assam.

*According to data, Directorate of Cashew nut and Cocoa Development Cashew Statistics Report 2021-22, top three **Cashew nut producer states** (in 2023-24) of India are-

Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Odisha.

* **Black pepper** is also known as black gold. It thrives in a hot and humid climate, with annual rainfall around 200 cm and hilly sloped with altitude ranging between 1100 to 1300 meters. It requires an average annual temperature between 15°C to 30°C.

* According to data Agriculture Statistics at a Glance 2023, in the year 2023-24 (Final data) top three **spice producing states** of India are 1. Madhya Pradesh, 2. Gujarat, 3. Andhra Pradesh.

* According to figures of 2022 India is the second largest producer of **Black Pepper** after Vietnam.

1. In which of the following Indian state cultivation of Coffee, rubber and tobacco is done ?

- (a) Karnataka (b) Meghalaya
(c) Goa (d) Maharashtra

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

Coffee producing States of India are-Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Odisha and some States of North East India. Rubber is produced in Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Tripura, Karnataka, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur and few other states. Tobacco is produced in Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, Karnataka, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra and some other States. Thus, these three crops are grown in Karnataka and Tamil Nadu state from the given options. Therefore, option (a) is answer correct.

2. The main crop cultivated in India under plantation agriculture is –

- (a) Tea, Rubber, coconut, coffee
(b) Tea, Rubber, Sunflower, Soyabean
(c) Tea, Banana, Grapes, Coconut
(d) Tea, Rubber, Coconut, Soyabean

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Ministry of Agriculture classifies coconut, arecanut, palm, cocoa and cashew nut under plantation crop. While according to the Ministry of Commerce, tea, coffee, and rubber are plantation crop. Thus, coconut, palm, arecanut, cocoa, cashew, tea, coffee and rubber are plantation crop.

3. Consider the following statements and select the correct answer from the given codes –

1. Tea is the main crop of Assam
2. Coffee is the main crop of Tamil Nadu

3. Tobacco is cultivated on a large scale in Andhra Pradesh.

4. Jute is the main crop of Chhattisgarh.

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1 and 3
(c) 1 and 4 (d) 2 and 3

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

Assam is the leading producer of tea. Andhra Pradesh is the top producer of tobacco when the question was asked (now Gujarat). Karnataka is a leading state in coffee production. The main crop of Chhattisgarh is paddy, not Jute therefore, code (1) and (3) are correct.

4. In India, more than one-third production of tobacco comes from –

- (a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Gujarat
(c) Karnataka (d) Uttar Pradesh

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

When this question was asked, more than one-third of the total production of tobacco came from Andhra Pradesh. According to 2022-23 data, the leading producer of tobacco is Gujarat with 58.09% of total production. Andhra Pradesh ranks second in terms of tobacco production.

5. Which state is the largest producer of 'Tobacco' in India?

- (a) Karnataka (b) Maharashtra
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Tamil Nadu

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

Among the given States, when the question was asked, Uttar Pradesh was the largest producer of tobacco, According to the 2022-23 data leading tobacco-producing States are as follows:-
Gujarat > Andhra Pradesh > Uttar Pradesh > Karnataka.

6. Which States is the largest producer of tobacco in India?

- (a) Gujarat (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Karnataka (d) Madhya Pradesh

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

7. Which of the following state of India has the largest area (2010) under tobacco cultivation?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh (b) Karnataka

- (c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Gujarat

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

Andhra Pradesh had the largest area under tobacco cultivation in 2010. According to 2022-23 data, four states with the largest area under tobacco cultivation are – Gujarat (192.85 thousand hectare), Karnataka (76 thousand hectare), Andhra Pradesh (58 thousand hectare) and Uttar Pradesh (23 thousand hectare).

8. The largest Coconut producing state in India is :

- (a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Karnataka
(c) Kerala (d) Tamil Nadu

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

When the question was asked option (c) was correct answer. According to 2023-24 data Karnataka is the leading producer of coconut and Tamil Nadu is now at second place in terms of coconut production. Kerala comes in third position in this regard.

9. Which one of the following states of India is the largest producer of coconut?

- (a) Kerala
(b) Karnataka
(c) Tamil Nadu
(d) Andhra Pradesh

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

When the question was asked option (a) was correct answer. According to data for the year 2023-24 provided by the Ministry of Agriculture, Government of India, three largest producers of coconut are –

Karnataka	–	28.78
Tamil Nadu	–	28.50
Kerala	–	25.84

10. Among the following spices, India is a leading producer of –

1. Black-Pepper 2. Cardamom
3. Cloves 4. Ginger

Select the correct answer from the following code :

- (a) 1 and 3 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1,2 and 4

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (*)

Among the given spices, India led in the production of Black-pepper and ginger when this question was asked, whereas leading producer of cardamom is Guatemala and leading producer of cloves is Indonesia. Therefore, none of the given code is correct. According to the figures of 2022 India is the second largest producer of Black Pepper after Vietnam.

11. Which of the following states is not known for the production of cardamom?

- (a) Kerala (b) Karnataka
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Odisha

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

When the question was asked option (d) was correct answer. According to the figures of 2023-24 (Final) Kerala, Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh are the leading producers of cardamom.

12. Kerala state is famous in the world for cultivating:

- (a) Rubber (b) Sugarcane
(c) Spices (d) Rice

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Kerala is famous for its spices from ancient times.

13. The state known as 'garden of spices' is –

- (a) Karnataka (b) Kerala
(c) Maharashtra (d) Tamil Nadu

U.P.P.C.S (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Due to the cultivation of several spices, Kerala is known as the 'garden of spices'. According to data for 2023-24 (Final Estimate), the leading producer of spices is Madhya Pradesh.

14. A state known to be as 'Spice Garden' is –

- (a) Kerala (b) Karnataka
(c) Tami Nadu (d) Gujarat

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Mains) 2010

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

15. Which of the following States is the largest producer of cardamom and pepper in India?

- (a) Tamil Nadu (b) Goa
(c) Kerala (d) Maharashtra

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

Kerala is the largest producer (2023-24) of Cardamom in India. Highest production of black pepper (2023-24 Final) is in Karnataka, and Kerala is in second place on this list. But due to the absence of Karnataka in the option, the correct answer is option (c) Kerala.

16. Cloves are obtained from –

- (a) Roots (b) Stem
(c) Fruits (d) Flower- bud

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Cloves are the flower- buds of medium-sized evergreen plant of *Eugenia Caryophyllata* Family. Clove is a variety of spice which is also used in medicines.

17. Farming of cloves is done in –

- (a) Kerala (b) Karnataka
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Uttar Pradesh

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (*)

According to 2023-24 (Final) data, farming of cloves is done in Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka. Hence the question asked is wrong.

18. Qualities of an Area in India are as follows –

- (1) Hot and moist climate
(2) 200 cm Annual Rainfall
(3) Mountain slopes of height up to 1100 meter
(4) 15°C to 30°C range of Annual temperature

Which of the following produces you will find most suitable to grow in the above type of climate :

- (a) Mustard (b) Cotton
(c) Black pepper (d) Virginia tobacco

I.A.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Black pepper is best grown in a hot and moist climate with at least 200cm of annual rainfall in the places with sloping heights of 1100 to 1300 metre and with a range of annual temperature from 15°C to 30°C.

19. Which of the following spice in India is known as 'Black diamond' -

- (a) Black pepper (b) Cardamom
(c) Cloves (d) Saffron

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (a)

Black pepper is also known as black diamond.

20. The biggest producer of spices in India is

- (a) Gujarat (b) Kerala
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Punjab

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (a)

When the question was asked Gujarat was biggest producer. According to data for 2023-24 (Final Estimate) the leading producer of spice is Madhya Pradesh.

21. Which of the following is a major producer of cashew nut?

- (a) Goa (b) Maharashtra
(c) Kerala (d) Karnataka

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

According to 2023-24 (Final) data, the three leading cashew nut producers in India are – Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Odisha.

22. The only state in India that produces saffron is :

- (a) Himachal Pradesh (b) Assam
(c) Jammu and Kashmir (d) Meghalaya
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above.

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Among the above options, the only saffron producing state in India is Jammu and Kashmir (Union territory since October 31, 2019). Saffron has been produced there since ancient times.

23. Which of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

- | List-I
(Crop/Plantation) | List - II
(Largest producer state) |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| A. Jute | 1. West Bengal |
| B. Tea | 2. Assam |
| C. Sugarcane | 3. Uttar Pradesh |
| D. Rubber | 4. Himachal Pradesh |

Codes -

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (b) | 3 | 1 | 2 | 4 |
| (c) | 2 | 4 | 3 | 1 |
| (d) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains), 2017

Ans. (d)

The rubber plant requires a warm and moist climate. In India, natural rubber is produced mainly in Kerala, Tripura, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Assam. India's largest rubber producing state is Kerala and not Himachal Pradesh.